

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Analyst | Detection Engineering | Microsoft Sentinel | Defender XDR | Vulnerability Management

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) with over five years of experience operating as a senior technical subject matter expert across incident response, detection engineering, cloud security and vulnerability management. I have built and continuously improved Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and detection engineering capabilities using Microsoft Sentinel and Kusto Query Language (KQL) within large-scale enterprise environments, and I bring hands-on expertise across the full Microsoft security ecosystem including Microsoft Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft Azure security technologies. I manage end-to-end vulnerability management programmes using Tenable.io and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), translating findings into prioritised, actionable remediation plans with technology stakeholders. I am experienced in leading the response to high-severity incidents in accordance with NIST 800-61 guidelines and enjoy embedding secure-by-design principles with infrastructure and engineering teams to continuously improve monitoring, detection, response and remediation capabilities across hybrid cloud environments.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM and Detection Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel, advanced Kusto Query Language (KQL) for detections, investigations and reporting, CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM)
- **Microsoft Defender XDR:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft Defender for Microsoft 365, Microsoft Defender for Cloud
- **Incident Response:** End-to-end management of P1 to P4 incidents, NIST 800-61, MITRE ATT&CK framework, triage, severity assessment, containment and post-incident review
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus; risk-based prioritisation and remediation tracking
- **Cloud Security:** Microsoft Azure, Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, secure-by-design principles, cloud posture improvement
- **Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR):** Logic Apps, automation playbook development and testing, PowerShell scripting
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent and EDR, Tanium
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Microsoft Entra ID, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), Conditional Access, BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Email and Endpoint Security:** Mimecast, Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM)
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2025 - Present

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

- Act as the senior technical subject matter expert for detection engineering within a Microsoft Sentinel Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) environment protecting more than 8,000 users, authoring high-fidelity Kusto Query Language (KQL) detection rules mapped to the MITRE ATT&CK framework to improve threat coverage and reduce false positives.
- Lead end-to-end management of cyber security incidents across Priority 1 to Priority 4 (P1-P4) severity levels in accordance with NIST 800-61 guidelines, taking ownership of triage, severity assessment, response coordination and post-incident review across global technology teams.

- Own the vulnerability management programme across infrastructure, cloud and endpoint environments using Tenable.io and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), translating vulnerability findings into risk-prioritised remediation plans and working with technology stakeholders to track closure.
- Administer and optimise Microsoft Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR) across endpoint, identity, cloud and email platforms, implementing and continuously refining security policies to reduce attack surface and improve detection fidelity.
- Build and maintain Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks and Microsoft Logic Apps automation workflows, reducing manual analyst effort and accelerating mean time to respond (MTTR) across the Security Operations Centre (SOC).
- Drive continuous improvement of cloud security posture across Microsoft Azure environments, collaborating with infrastructure and engineering teams to embed secure-by-design principles in change processes and configuration reviews.
- Conduct proactive threat hunting operations across CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM) and Microsoft Sentinel telemetry, identifying anomalous behaviour and reducing adversary dwell time.
- Communicate complex technical findings and security metrics to senior stakeholders, supporting risk-informed decision making and demonstrating clear long-term improvement in the organisation's security posture.

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2022 - March 2025

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

- Triaged and investigated security alerts across Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), using advanced Kusto Query Language (KQL) to reduce mean time to detect (MTTD) and mean time to respond (MTTR).
- Supported the deployment, configuration and ongoing management of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across an 8,000-user environment, improving detection coverage across endpoints and identity attack paths.
- Managed Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access policies, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) and Single Sign-On (SSO) to protect identity and enforce least-privilege access across the organisation.
- Performed vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io, AppCheck and Nessus, prioritising findings by risk severity and business impact, and coordinating with infrastructure teams to drive remediation.
- Authored, tested and maintained incident response playbooks aligned to NIST 800-61, conducting tabletop exercises to strengthen organisational resilience and readiness.
- Collaborated with infrastructure and engineering teams to review configuration changes and ensure alignment with security standards including ISO 27001, CIS Controls and Cyber Essentials Plus.

HICX Solutions Ltd (Software as a Service / Financial Technology)

February 2021 - March 2022

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

- Implemented and managed endpoint security controls and vulnerability scanning across a hybrid cloud infrastructure, identifying and remediating security weaknesses in line with risk management policies.
- Supported identity and access management using Active Directory and cloud identity platforms, enforcing Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) and access governance controls.
- Managed email security controls including Mimecast gateway configuration, reducing phishing and malware delivery to end users.
- Contributed to ISO 27001 compliance activities, security policy development and cross-functional security awareness initiatives.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Led the deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) across 8,000 users at UAL, delivering comprehensive endpoint detection and response (EDR) coverage and significantly improving the organisation's ability to detect and respond to threats at scale.
- Engineered a library of high-fidelity Kusto Query Language (KQL) detection rules within Microsoft Sentinel, reducing false-positive alert volumes and improving the signal-to-noise ratio across the Security Operations Centre (SOC).

- Built a suite of Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks using Microsoft Logic Apps, automating triage and initial response actions and reducing manual analyst effort across common incident types.
- Directed the vulnerability management programme through integration of Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), enabling continuous, automated testing of attack paths and prioritising the highest-risk remediation activities.
- Supported UAL in achieving and maintaining Cyber Essentials Plus certification, demonstrating robust technical controls across firewalls, secure configuration, access control, malware protection and patch management.

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)